

Device	Main Function	Real-Life Example
Modem	Connects your home or office network to your Internet Service Provider (ISP) by converting signals between the ISP's network and your local network.	At home: A cable or fiber modem connects your house to the internet.
Router	Directs data between devices on your local network and the internet, allowing multiple devices to share one internet connection.	At home: A Wi-Fi router lets your phone, laptop, and TV all use the same internet connection.
Switch	Connects multiple wired devices within the same local network and sends data only to the intended device.	In an office: A network switch connects desktop computers, printers, and servers using Ethernet cables.
Access Point (AP)	Provides wireless (Wi-Fi) access to a wired network, allowing wireless devices to connect.	At a school or shopping mall: Wi-Fi access points provide wireless internet coverage throughout the building.
Network Cable (Ethernet Cable)	Physically carries data between network devices for a fast and reliable wired connection.	At home or in an office: An Ethernet cable connects a computer, gaming console, or switch to the router.